

Novella

What then, Raman?

- Shirley L Arora

About the author

Dr. Shirley Arora → American Scholar

Spanish
Portuguese
lang &
literature

About the Novella

What then, Raman → Also known as

"Tiger on the
mountain"

→ Pub 1960

Setting → Hill station → Southern India

Theme → Ambition
→ Sacrifice
→ Family

Learning → Transform → life

characters

① Raman → Protagonist young boy from poor hill town in Southern India & first village boy to learn how to read

② The American Scholar → Researching native Indian flora & hires Raman to

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called them

- (3) Raman's father $\rightarrow$ woodcutter & in Bullock and sells fireworks. Though illiterate knows the value of education
- (4) munnusamy $\rightarrow$ schoolmaster (Arithmetic teacher)
- (5) Tumbusamy $\rightarrow$ Book seller
- (6) Raman's mother - Vegetable seller
- (7) vacanti $\rightarrow$ 7 years old sister of Raman
- (8) Daan - 5 year old brother of Raman
- (9) small baby boy $\rightarrow$ Raman
- (10) Salloarl & mutlu $\rightarrow$ Boys from school

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dinner Raman sat outside - the house and drew 35 lines dividing into 4 groups, yet one line was pending so he was annoyed with the answer. Raman's mother said - there is she left out only for two days too for the family, Raman's father would he would go back plains and sent some money, but Raman have to leave the school to help the family.

chapter - 3

'It is just a dream'

Raman and Dasan plucked vegetables and Vasanti counted them and placed in a basket, Raman's father packed a tinbox and his mother carried a Vegetable Marching towards the Market. Raman was worried as nothing change for Dasan, he is too small but Raman have give up everything.

Last year Raman's father hooked for a job at the plains and there was no scarcity but this year is not the same. Now everyone have to be feeded including the small boy and it was difficult for the family. Vasanti and Dasan was given a small coin in bus stand by they are father to by the sweets but there is also coin for Raman and his father.

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knew he would not buy sweet instead saved the money to buy a book

The father said,
"I'm sorry about our schooling, Raman I know how much it means to you, perhaps after I have found a job and have been able to send money..."

Raman's father insisted to leave a naaye paisa from every Rupee for himself he also said he too dreamt to become more than a woodcutter but it was just a dream

Chapter - 4

"A Naaye-paise for myself"

Raman went to school to meet his school master who was dressed him white veshti long cotton cloth around around is waist and long white long shirt Raman thought he too one day will wear angavastram like that. Raman informed the Master he would not join the school anymore his father left to the plains so he has to look after the family. Raman said he will be keeping one Naaye-paise from a Rupee for himself. So he has to earn 25 Rupees to get 25 naaye-paise to buy a book - of animal fables translated Sanskrit of ancient Indian, Tamil poems stories about

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revenge on people, but Raman thinks it's crazy to think about an animal seeking revenge. It's his uncle who said a year ago that Raman was an example for the change in lives of hill people, but today he left school due to financial problems.

chapter - 6

'The Mertin lady & the hill flowers'

Three weeks passed and no information came from Raman's father, which meant that he hadn't found any job. There were plenty of vegetables left as nothing sold out, the picked mushrooms were dried as unsold. They even tried to pick berries but there was no market for them. Raman got an idea to sell flowers as he already helped his uncle sometimes to pick flowers when he worked as a garden.

Raman picked flowers, breaking too long and went into one bungalow. It was locked, another locked, another locked. At the end of the Mountain from one bungalow there was a snake coming out. He saw Sundaram (cook) at Mertin's bungalow and asked if Madam is in need of flowers.

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but there were plenty of flowers in the garden entirely yet he met the Merkin lady seated in a wheel chair with a broken leg in the garden & asked whether she's in need of flowers. The Merkin lady replied in that case, if you could find the hill flowers bring in to me & I will pay you for it.

Chapter-7

'In search of the hill flowers'

Raman along with Varanti hung empty bags and went in search of Pine cones. Each time he bent to pick a cone, he searched for the hill flowers. Varanti filled two bags but Raman filled one, when he went to drink water by a near by stream and lied down holding his face towards the ground he saw a pink blur in front of him and said

'A hill flower' This is a rare flowers which is not found in Merkin lady's garden. He started picking it & putting it into his bag & sent Varanti back home here. By the time he reached the big bungalow the flowers were sorry sight, the petals crumpled and closed, stems dropped. The Merkin lady looked at the flowers and said she can't get those as it's already dried up. In case she is

Vegetables and spices for the curry his mom asked to take 16 naye paise (11 naye-paise + 5 he earned from two clays)

Raman saw a original book enveloped neatly and titled "the Ramayana" the story of Rama war between Ram and demon king (Ravana is loka who kidnap Sita) It is 10 Rupees But can sell it for 7 Rupees are even or 6.5 Rupees not pain he Raman said "Tata some day I am going to buy that book" (650 naye-paise sale)

Chapter - 10

"A Book with pictures"

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Three days Pass the coins lalled Paiced to '38 now' each time he Passed the bookstore he looked at the gold titled book "Ramayana" He just told himself "Some day I am going to buy that book"

Every week his father sent money, new clothes for Baby was brought and a Vessed to look food and there was no scarcity for food. It was day by day difficult to find flowers,

to go fetch it the next to early morning

Chapter - 13

"A crack closer now"

Raman began his journey in the early morning and though the sun was on his head, still didn't reach the orchids. He thought whether Tata Natarajan really knew about the forest flower or not and kept moving forward. A sound disturbed him, turned back yet, nothing found now there it was! a crack, close now.

An Animal, a large animal was moving through the jungle following Raman's steps. Yellow eye..... He screams.

chapter - 14

"Nine Rupees in total"

Raman was terrified and kept running near a large tree and reached its first branch to keep climbing higher and higher until he almost fell down with fear when he look down it was a cow, when he got up to see a large tree with big leaves and it contains pink flowers like butterfly. he started climbing to collect the yellow

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each time he found a rare flowers extra money was added to him. One day when he brought a 'lilly plant growing half way up', he received '1 rupee' for a plant

Merkin lady thanked Raman for helping her speak tamil, informed 'about school, college' for older boys & girls below the plains. But Raman was shocked to hear girls study, because he believed girls would cook & marry and keep the house clean. She said at school she also teach 'how to farm, raise better crops, build better houses, to prepare meals & care for the ill'. Raman also was interested to join Sub School who was '12 years old' now.

Raman was proud of being the first to go to school, said he's going to be Scholar some day, will own many, many books on shelves & need to learn many, many things. Merkin lady listened carefully without telling anything. Raman thought why is she always painting, for what?

"I am going to make a book, Raman, a book with pictures of all the flowers grow in these hills"

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